ECON 2106: Principles of Microeconomics (Spring 2027)

General Course Information

Instructor:	Dr. Joshua Martin	**Email:**	joshua@westga.edu
Office:	338 Roy Richards Sr. Hall	**Office Hours:**	MW 1:30-3:00pm, or by apt.
Course Delivery:	In-Person	**Section:**	03
Meetings:	MW 9:00am-10:15am	**Location:**	TBA Roy Richards Sr. Hall

Prerequisite

N/A

Course Description

Principles of Microeconomics provides strong explanations for observed prices and quantities that you see in everyday life, and gives insights as to the tradeoffs people face when making decisions. In this class we will discuss many topics, including comparative advantage, supply and demand, taxes and subsidies, profits and costs, firm and industry structure, competition, government behavior in markets.

Course Textbook

David Shapiro, Daniel MacDonald, and Steven A. Greenlaw. *Principles of Microeconomics 3e* (2022)

Course Goals

- The overall objective of this course is for you to learn basic economic concepts and more about the economic system in which we live. To this end, upon completion of the course a student will be able to:
  1. describe basic economic concepts such as scarcity and opportunity costs (LG4, LG8)
  2. summarize in writing the key microeconomic concepts contained in an article from a business periodical, e.g., the Wall Street Journal (LG1),
  3. demonstrate a basic knowledge of microeconomics including concepts such as utility maximization, elasticity costs, market structure and labor markets (LG4, LG8),
  4. demonstrate a basic knowledge of international economics including concepts such as comparative advantage, specialization and gains to trade (LG4, LG5, LG8, LG9),
  5. recognize ethical and economic dimensions of government involvement in markets including regulation and the provision of public goods (LG5, LG8), and
  6. analyze current events using economic models such as supply and demand (LG4, LG8)
     - Critical Thinking Overlay: This class involves critical thinking and is designed to satisfy the Critical Thinking overlay component of the UWG core curriculum, as follows: "Students will demonstrate the ability to interpret, analyze, evaluate and explain various kinds of evidence, statements, and arguments." For this class, students will be required to evaluate firm production decisions, consumer choices, market interventions, specialization, and market structures. Student evaluation on both exams and homework assignments will consist of problems designed to assess student ability to recognize and compare/contrast different economic decisions.
     - Note: A complete list of expected learning goals (LG) for the Economics Department can be found at the department web site http://www.westga.edu/econ/index_12904.php

Grading

Evaluation Policies

- All exams are closed notes and must be completed in class.
  - Any substantiated or suspected academic dishonesty will result in immediate course failure and referral for further disciplinary action.
- Make-up Policy:
  - There are no make-ups for missed assignments.
  - Assignments missed due to an excused absence will be replaced with the average of the remaining assignment scores.
  - Excused absences require documentation from a medical professional or relevant university official.
  - Two or more missed, excused exams will result in an incomplete grade for the semester.
- Attendance
  - Most classes will open with a 5 question, 10 minute quiz that is administered online.
  - Completion of these assignments will be used to determine attendance; thus, the grades for the quizzes serve only to signal where focus one's studies before an exam.
  - Students will be randomized into tables before each class and can work together with others at their table.
  - Students must display their (provided) name tent during the quiz in order to receive credit for being present.
  - Non-supervised completed quizzes will be treated as an academic dishonesty incident.

Exams

$$Exams = \begin{cases} 20 \times \sum_{e=1}^{5} Exam_e & \text{if } Exam_5 \leq min(Exam_{1-4}), \\ 20 \times \left(\sum_{e=1}^{4} Exam_e - \min(Exam_e) \right) + 40 \times Exam_5 & \text{if } Exam_5 > min(Exam_{1-4}) \end{cases}$$

where $0 \leq Exam \leq 1$.

Exam Curves

- I write exams to be challenging, so I apply a consistent curve to keep the grading scale fair and to avoid "extra credit–style" outcomes where top scores vastly exceed 100. The size of each student's curve is proportional to their attendance: students who attend every class receive the full curve, and students who never attend receive none.
  - Let g_i denote student i's raw exam score out of 100 points, and let $a_i \in [0, 1]$ denote the share of class meetings student i attended.
  - Each student receives a bonus of $c_i = k \cdot a_i$ points, where $k \geq 0$ is the smallest integer such that either the class mean curved score satisfies $\bar{f} \geq 75$ or the average curve satisfies $\bar{f} - \bar{g} \geq 25$, whichever comes first.
  - For example, if $k = 30$, a student who attended 80% of classes receives $c_i = 0.8 \times 30 = 24$ bonus points, while a student who attended 50% receives $c_i = 15$.
  - Each student's curved score is then:

$$f(g_i) = \min \left\{ \frac{c_i}{2} + \frac{g_i + c_i}{100} \times \left(100 - \frac{c_i}{2} \right),\ 100 \right\}$$

Grade Scale

Grade	Range
A	[90,100+)
B	[80, 90)
C	[70, 80)
D	[60, 70)
F	[0, 60)

Artificial Intelligence Use Policy

Generative Artificial Intelligence (Gen AI) is not allowed in any coursework. All coursework must be original and created for this course. Use of Gen AI will be treated as plagiarism. Any violations of this guideline will be subject to the academic and disciplinary policies listed in the UWG Honor Code (see: Student Handbook).

Roster Verification

In order to be counted as having attended class during the roster verification period, you must complete at least one quiz by February 1, 2027. If I mark you as not-attending for a course, you will receive a 'W' grade.

Changes to the Syllabus

I reserve the right to modify the course schedule or content as necessary to support the learning objectives of the class. Any such changes will be communicated in advance and will only be made in ways that are beneficial to students, such as reducing the scope of material covered or delaying assignment due dates.

Student Etiquette

- Expectation of Course Attendance
  - Students are expected to attend class regularly, remain actively engaged, take notes, and participate in collaborative discussions with their peers.
  - Absences will only be excused with appropriate documentation from a medical professional or a relevant UWG employee.
- Electronic Devices
  - Students may use laptops and tablets to aid in note-taking.
  - No headphones during class time.
  - Students who need to text or make a call should step outside the classroom.
  - Lecture slides will be provided to students in advance, and in return, students are not permitted to record or photograph during lectures.
- Communication
  - Face-to-face communication is strongly preferred to email correspondence.
  - I request that non-urgent questions be reserved to times in the classroom or during office hours.
  - Students who email questions already answered in the syllabus (including extension requests) will lose points on their next exam:
    - 1 point (out of 20) for the first offense
    - 10 points for the second
    - 20 points on the next exam for the third
- Disruptions
  - Any disruption to class will result in a zero on the next exam.
  - Any second distribution will result in course failure.

Course Schedule

Date	Readings	Material	Due
01/11/27	Syllabus	Course introduction	
01/13/27	Ch. 1 (1.1-1.2)	Introduction to Economics	Quiz 1
01/18/27	*MLK Day*		
01/20/27	Ch. 1 (1.3-1.4)	Economic Systems	Quiz 2
01/25/27	Ch. 2 (2.1-2.2)	Opportunity Costs	Quiz 3
01/27/27	Ch. 2 (2.3)	Budget & Production Constraints	Quiz 4
02/01/27	Ch. 19 (19.1-19.2)	Gains from Trade	Quiz 5
02/03/27	Ch. 19 (19.3-19.4)	Smith & The Wealth of Nations	Quiz 6
02/08/27		Ch. 1-2, 19	**Exam 1**
02/10/27	Ch. 3 (3.1-3.2)	Supply & Demand	Quiz 7
02/15/27	Ch. 5 (5.1-5.2)	Elasticity	Quiz 8
02/17/27	Ch. 3 (3.3-3.4)	Market (Dis)equilibirum	Quiz 9
02/22/27	Ch. 3 (3.5)	Market Efficiency & Welfare	Quiz 10
02/24/27	Ch. 4 (4.1-4.2)	Shocks to Equilibrium	Quiz 11
03/01/27	Ch. 3 (4.3)	Price Theory	Quiz 12
03/03/27		Ch. 3-5	**Exam 2**
03/08/27	Ch. 12 (12.1-12.3)	Negative Externalities	Quiz 13
03/10/27	Ch. 12 (12.4-12.6)	Taxes & Subsidies	Quiz 14
03/15/27	*Spring Break*		
03/17/27	*Spring Break*		
03/22/27	Ch. 13 (13.1-13.2)	Positive Externalities	Quiz 15
03/24/27	Ch. 13 (13.3)	Public Goods	Quiz 16
03/29/27	Ch. 18 (18.1-18.2)	Public Choice Theory	Quiz 17
03/31/27	Ch. 18 (18.3)	Rent Seeking	Quiz 18
04/05/27		Ch. 12-13, 18	**Exam 3**
04/07/27	Ch. 7 (7.1-7.3)	Production Costs	Quiz 19
04/12/27	Ch. 7 (7.4-7.5)	Industry Structure	Quiz 20
04/14/27	Ch. 8 (8.1-8.2)	Perfect Competition	Quiz 21
04/19/27	Ch. 8 (8.3-8.4)	Market Entry & Exit	Quiz 22
04/21/27	Ch. 9 (9.1-9.2)	Monopoly	Quiz 23
04/26/27	Ch. 10 (10.1)	Imperfect Competition	Quiz 24
04/28/27	Ch. 10 (10.2)	Game Theory	Quiz 25
05/03/27		Ch. 7-10	**Exam 4**
05/10/27		Ch. 1-5, 7-10, 12-13, 18-19	**Final Exam**

Student Resources

Accessibility Services

Students with a documented disability may work with UWG Accessibility Services to receive essential services specific to their disability. All entitlements to accommodations are based on documentation and USG Board of Regents standards.

If a student needs course adaptations or accommodations because of a disability or chronic illness, or if they need to make special arrangements in case the building must be evacuated, the student should notify their instructor in writing and provide a copy of their Student Accommodations Report (SAR), which is available only from Accessibility Services. Faculty cannot offer accommodations without timely receipt of the SAR; further, no retroactive accommodations will be given.

For more information, please contact Accessibility Services.

Center for Academic Success

The Center for Academic Success provides services, programs, and opportunities including academic coaching, peer tutoring, drop-in tutoring and supplemental instruction to help all undergraduate students succeed academically.

For more information, contact them: (678) 839-6280 or cas@westga.edu.

Mental Health Support

If you or another student are experiencing a mental health issue, free and confidential services are available through the Counseling Center.

Students who have experienced sexual or domestic violence can access confidential support through Patient Advocates in Health Services.

To report a concern anonymously, please visit UWG Cares.

English Language Learning (ELL) Resources

If you are having difficulty with English or U.S. academic culture, specialized resources are available to help you succeed. Visit the ELL Resource Page for more information.

Title IX & Equal Opportunity

University of West Georgia faculty are committed to helping create a safe and open learning environment for all students. If you (or someone you know) have experienced any form of sexual misconduct, including sexual assault, dating or domestic violence, or stalking, know that help and support are available. The University strongly encourages all members of the community to take action, seek support, and report incidents of sexual misconduct to the Office of Title IX & Equal Opportunity. Please be aware that under Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972, I am required to disclose information about such misconduct to the Office of Title IX & Equal Opportunity. If you wish to speak to a confidential employee who does not have this reporting responsibility, you can contact the University of West Georgia Counseling Center (678-839-6428) or Advocate Services (470-215-9946).